

Home & Accommodation

Whether you're staying at a hotel for a weekend, renting an Airbnb, or settling into a Swedish apartment — this chapter has every phrase you need for housing situations. Including the sacred tvättstuga.

Checking In & Out

Swedish hotels are typically efficient and no-nonsense. Check-in is smooth, staff speak English, and everything just works. But knowing these phrases shows effort and helps with smaller, family-run places.

Jag har en bokning

/yah har en BOOK-ning/

I have a reservation.

Bokning under namnet...

/BOOK-ning OON-der NAHM-net/

Reservation under the name... — Follow with your name.

Jag vill checka in

/yah vill SHEH-kah in/

I want to check in.

Jag vill checka ut

/yah vill SHEH-kah oot/

I want to check out.

Vilken våning?

/VIL-ken VOH-ning/

Which floor?

Hiss

/hiss/

Elevator — 'Var är hissen?' = Where is the elevator?

Har ni Wi-Fi?

/har nee WHY-fy/

Do you have Wi-Fi?

Vad är Wi-Fi-lösenordet?

/vah air WHY-fy-LUH-sen-OR-det/

What's the Wi-Fi password?

Kan jag lämna väskan här?

/kan yah LEM-nah VES-kan hair/

Can I leave my bag here? — Useful when checking out before your flight.

När är frukost?

/nair air FR00-kost/

When is breakfast? — Swedish hotel breakfasts are legendary. Don't miss them.

CULTURE TIP

Swedish hotel breakfasts are often incredible buffets: fresh bread, cheese, cold cuts, smoked salmon, boiled eggs, muesli, yogurt, fruit, juice, and always great coffee. Many Swedes consider the hotel breakfast the highlight of a hotel stay. Some hotels even serve homemade bread and local specialties. Eat well — you're paying for it.

Airbnb & Rental Communication

If you're renting an apartment through Airbnb or a private host, you might need to communicate about practical things. These phrases cover the basics of arriving, leaving, and asking questions.

Var hämtar jag nyckeln?

/var HEM-tar yah NYCK-eĭn/

Where do I pick up the key?

Nyckelbox / Kodlås

/NYCK-eĭ-box / KOHD-lohs/

Key box / Code lock — Very common for Airbnb self check-in.

Vad är koden?

/vah air KOH-den/

What's the code?

Var lämnar jag nyckeln?

/var LEM-nar yah NYCK-eĭn/

Where do I leave the key? — When checking out.

Var slänger jag soporna?

/var SLENG-er yah SOH-por-nah/

Where do I throw away the trash?

Hur fungerar spisen?

/hoor fun-GEH-rar SPEE-sen/

How does the stove work? — Swedish stoves can be confusing. Induction is common.

Var är extra sängkläder?

/var air EX-trah SENG-kleh-der/

Where are extra bedsheets/blankets?

Kan jag förlänga min vistelse?

/kan yah fur-LENG-ah min vis-TEL-seh/

Can I extend my stay?

CULTURE TIP

Swedish recycling is serious. Most apartments have separate bins for: matavfall (food waste), plast (plastic), papper (paper), glas (glass), and metall (metal). Your host will likely explain the system. Don't mix everything in one bag — your neighbors will notice.

When Things Break

Staying longer? Things break, stop working, or behave strangely. Here's how to report problems to your landlord, host, or building manager.

...fungerar inte

/fun-GEH-rar IN-teh/

...isn't working — Add anything before this. 'Duschen fungerar inte' = The shower isn't working.

Varmvattnet fungerar inte

/VARM-vah-net fun-GEH-rar IN-teh/

The hot water isn't working — A winter nightmare.

Värmen är trasig

/VEHR-men air TRAH-sig/

The heating is broken — In a Swedish winter, this is urgent.

Toaletten är igensatt

/toh-ah-LEH-ten air EE-gen-saht/

The toilet is clogged.

Wi-Fi fungerar inte

/WHY-fy fun-GEH-rar IN-teh/

The Wi-Fi isn't working.

Det läcker vatten

/deh LEH-ker VAH-ten/

There's a water leak.

Jag har låst mig ute

/yah har lohst mey 00-teh/

I've locked myself out — It happens to everyone.

Lampan är trasig

/LAHM-pan air TRAH-sig/

The light is broken.

Fönstret går inte att stänga

/FUN-stret gohr IN-teh aht STENG-ah/

The window won't close.

Jag behöver en reparatör

/yah beh-HUH-ver en reh-pah-rah-TUR/

I need a repairman.

CULTURE TIP

If you lock yourself out of a Swedish apartment, call a locksmith (låssmed). Be warned: emergency locksmith calls can cost 2,000-4,000 SEK or more, especially at night or on weekends. Always keep a spare key somewhere safe, or give one to a trusted friend or neighbor.

The Tvättstuga — Sweden's Sacred Laundry Room

If you stay in any Swedish apartment building, you will encounter the tvättstuga — the shared laundry room. This is not just a room with washing machines. It is a battleground of scheduling, passive-aggressive notes, and unwritten rules. Swedes take the tvättstuga VERY seriously.

Tvättstuga

/TVEHT-stoo-gah/

Shared laundry room — Every apartment building has one.

Hur bokar jag tvättstugan?

/hoor B00-kar yah TVEHT-stoo-gahn/

How do I book the laundry room? — You **MUST** book a time slot.

Tvättmaskin

/TVEHT-mah-sheen/

Washing machine.

Torktumlare

/TORK-toom-lah-reh/

Dryer / Tumble dryer.

Torkskåp

/TORK-skohp/

Drying cabinet — A warm cabinet to hang clothes in. Very Swedish, very effective.

Torkrum

/TORK-room/

Drying room — A warm room with clotheslines.

Tvättmedel

/TVEHT-meh-deL/

Laundry detergent.

Sköljmedel

/SHULJ-meh-deL/

Fabric softener.

Kulörtvätt / Vittvätt

/koo-LURT-tveht / VIT-tveht/

Colors wash / Whites wash — Separate programs on the machine.

Är tvättstugan ledig?

/air TVEHT-stoo-gahn LEH-dig/

Is the laundry room available?

CULTURE TIP

THE GOLDEN RULES OF THE TVÄTTSTUGA: 1) NEVER go over your booked time. If your slot is 7-10 and you're there at 10:05, expect a passive-aggressive note — or worse, direct confrontation. 2) Clean the lint filter after using the dryer. 3) Wipe down machines when done. 4) Remove your clothes immediately when done. 5) NEVER touch someone else's laundry. Even if their time is up and they left clothes behind, you wait. Maybe leave a polite note. Maybe. Break these rules and you will become the building's villain.

Household Vocabulary

Useful words for navigating any Swedish home or apartment.

Kök / Badrum / Sovrum / Vardagsrum

/shuhk / BAHD-room / SOHV-room / VAR-dahgs-room/

Kitchen / Bathroom / Bedroom / Living room.

Balkong / Trappa / Källare / Vind

/bal-KONG / TRAP-ah / SHEL-ah-reh / vind/

Balcony / Stairs / Basement / Attic.

Kylskåp / Frys / Ugn / Mikrovågsugn

/SHYL-skohp / fryhs / oong / MEE-kroh-vohgs-oong/

Fridge / Freezer / Oven / Microwave.

Diskmaskin

/DISK-mah-sheen/

Dishwasher — Very common in Swedish apartments.

Dammsugare

/DAHM-soo-gah-reh/

Vacuum cleaner — Literally 'dust sucker.'

Sopor / Soprum

/SOH-por / SOHP-room/

Trash / Trash room — Where the building's bins are.

Portkod

/PORT-kohd/

Door entry code — Most Swedish apartment buildings have a code to enter.

Hyresvärd / Fastighetsägare

/HYH-res-vaird / fas-TIG-hets-EH-gah-reh/

Landlord / Property owner.

CULTURE TIP

Shoes off at the door! This is non-negotiable in Swedish homes. When you enter any Swedish home — even for a party — you take your shoes off at the entrance. Every Swedish home has a designated shoe area. Some even have guest slippers (tofflor). If you walk in with shoes on, you will get a look that could freeze a volcano.

Neighbors & Building Life

Swedish apartment living has unwritten rules about noise, common areas, and neighbor interaction. Here's what you need to know.

Hej, jag är din nya granne

/hey, yah air din NYH-ah GRAN-eh/

Hi, I'm your new neighbor — A nice first impression.

Förlåt för oljudet

/fur-LOHT fur OH-yoo-det/

Sorry for the noise.

Tystnad efter klockan 22

/TYHST-nahd EF-ter KLOK-an SHOO-goh-tvoh/

Quiet after 10 PM — The standard rule in most buildings.

Trapphus

/TRAP-hoos/

Stairwell — Keep it clean and quiet.

Innergård

/IN-er-gohrd/

Inner courtyard — Many Swedish buildings have beautiful shared courtyards.

CULTURE TIP

Noise rules in Swedish apartments are taken seriously. Most buildings have a rule: quiet after 22:00 (10 PM). Loud music, parties, or even loud conversations after this time can result in complaints to the landlord. If you're having a party, let your neighbors know in advance — a small note in the stairwell goes a long way. Swedes appreciate the heads-up.

Listen to This Chapter

Scan the QR code to hear every phrase pronounced naturally. No robot voices — just real Swedish.

Next up: Chapter 09 — Weather & Seasons

Weather is the #1 small talk topic in Sweden. Master it and you'll always have something to say.